The Fourth Sheet

Example report · SMEs

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Which jobs actually make money?

Period: February 2026. Every job's gross margin: revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time at $68 an hour (fully loaded: wages and all on-costs). Pick a type of job and every number, chart and note on the page follows it.

How final is this data?

February 2026 Locked February 2026 is locked (closed 3 Mar 2026). These numbers won't change.

In short: Jobs made a 44.9% gross margin in February: maintenance contracts the most (63.9%), installations the least (38.6%).

Gross margin, not profit

Gross margin is not profit. Job gross margin = revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time charged to the job at $68 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: technician time not charged to any job (travel, training, waiting), and overheads (office wages, marketing, vehicles, rent, insurance, IT, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages include their on-costs: super (12%) and leave as it's earned. No payroll tax: wages are under Queensland's $1.3 million threshold.

From gross margin to profit

February's jobs made $98,246 gross margin (44.9%). Technician time not charged to jobs took $12,920 and overheads $59,320, leaving $26,006 profit before tax (11.9% of revenue). To cover overheads, jobs need a 33.0% gross margin on average.

Gross margin on jobs	$98,246
Technician wages and on-costs	$72,352
Technician time charged to jobs (at cost)	$59,432
Technician time not charged to jobs	$12,920
Gross profit (the P&L)	$85,326
Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest)	$59,320
Profit before tax (the P&L)	$26,006
Revenue	$218,908
Gross margin on jobs, %	44.9%
Profit before tax, % of revenue	11.9%
Gross margin jobs need just to cover overheads and time not charged	**33.0%**

Type of job: All jobs

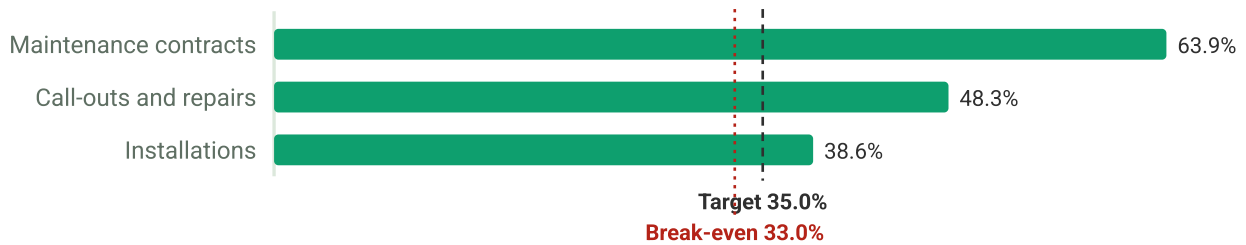
Job gross margin, February · All jobs
44.9%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, January · All jobs
41.9%
target 35.0%

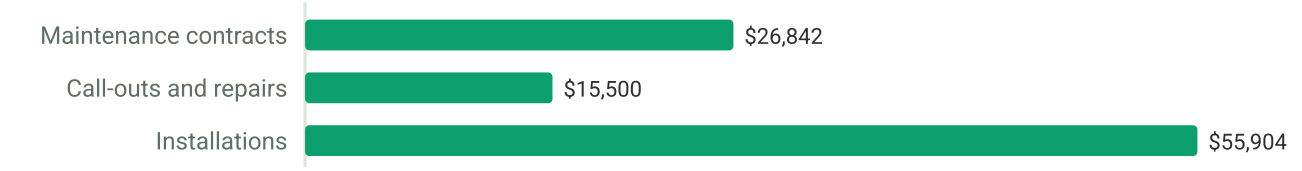
Gross margin jobs need to break even
33.0%
covers overheads and time not charged (February)

Job gross margin by type of job, February 2026

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

In February maintenance contracts made a 63.9% job gross margin, installations made a 38.6% job gross margin, call-outs and repairs made a 48.3% job gross margin (technician time at $68 an hour, wages and all on-costs). Jobs need 33.0% just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Installations: 38.6% gross margin, 3.6 points over the 35.0% target ($5,224 ahead on $144,800 in February). Maintenance contracts: 63.9% gross margin, 28.9 points over the 35.0% target ($12,142 ahead on $42,000 in February).

Type of job: Maintenance contracts

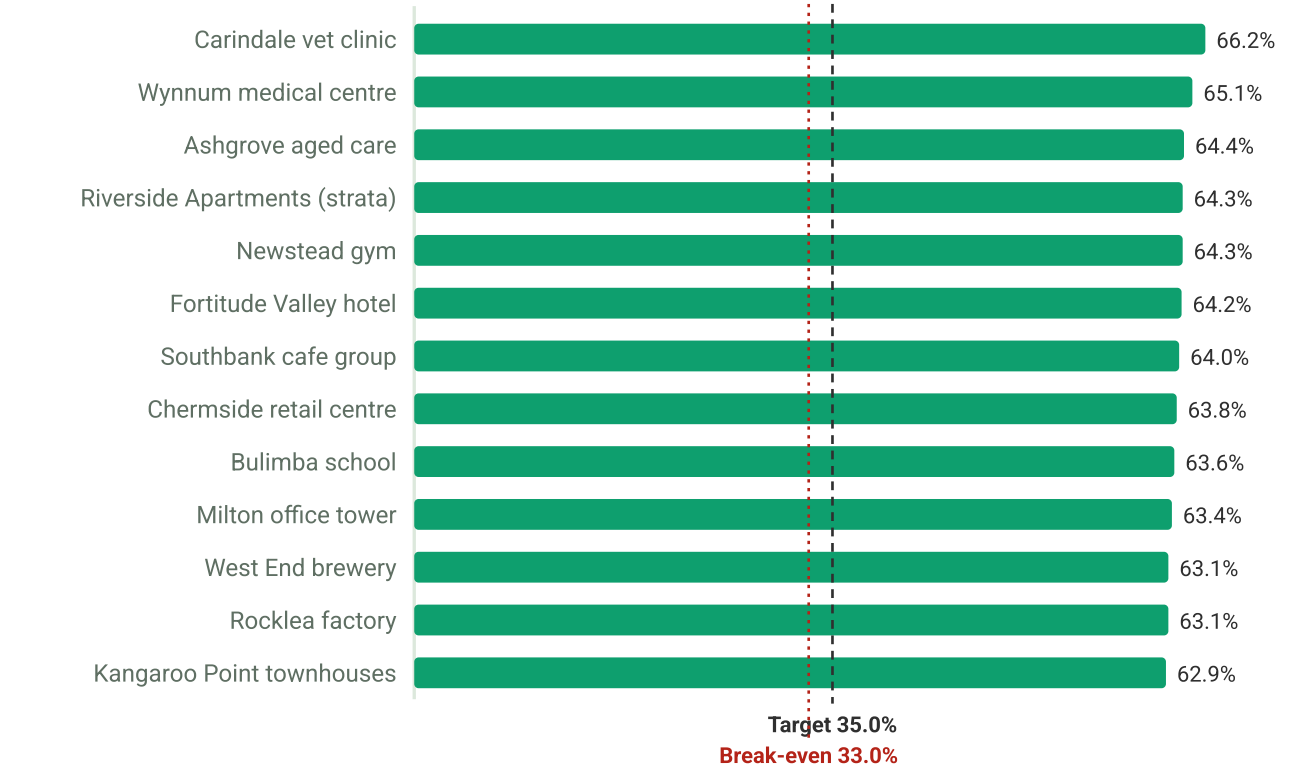
Job gross margin, February · Maintenance contracts
63.9%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, January · Maintenance contracts
63.8%
target 35.0%

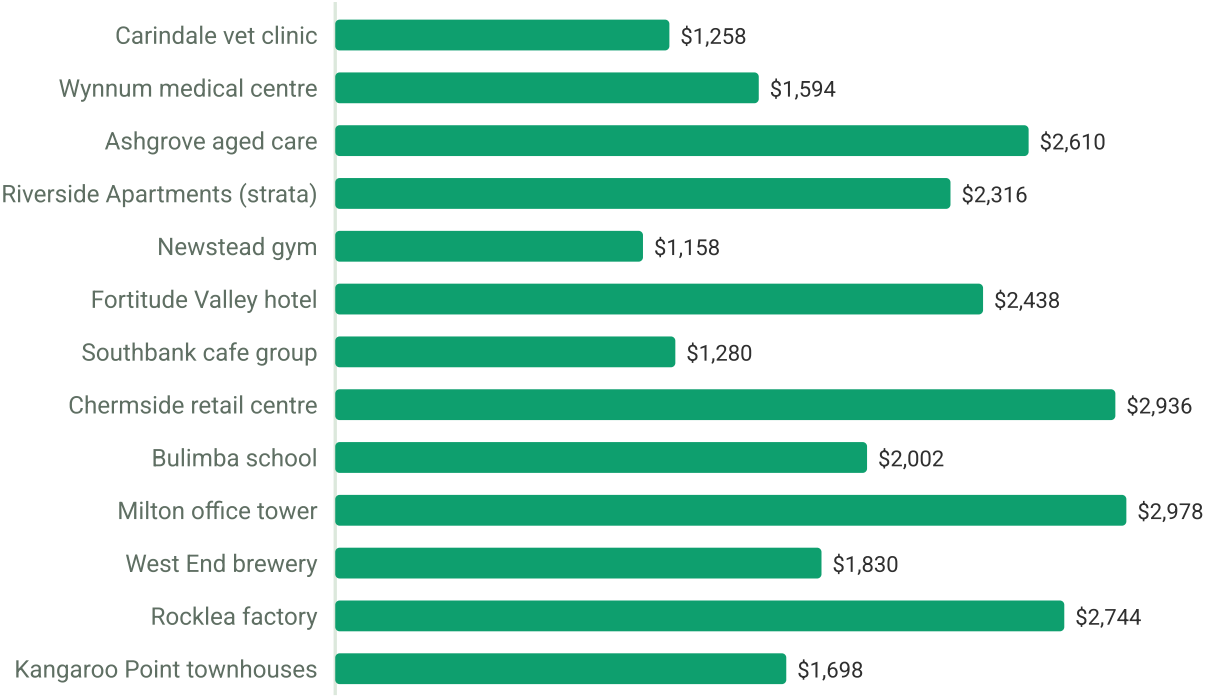
Gross margin jobs need to break even
33.0%
covers overheads and time not charged (February)

Job gross margin on each maintenance contract, February 2026

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

All 13 contracts made more than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The thinnest was Kangaroo Point townhouses at 62.9% job gross margin: 14.0 h of technician time on a $2,700 monthly fee.

What you'd do about it

The thinnest, Kangaroo Point townhouses: 62.9% gross margin, 27.9 points over the 35.0% target ($753 ahead on $2,700 in February). All maintenance contracts: 63.9% gross margin, 28.9 points over the 35.0% target ($12,142 ahead on $42,000 in February).

Type of job: Installations

Job gross margin, February · Installations
38.6%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, January · Installations
32.0%
target 35.0%

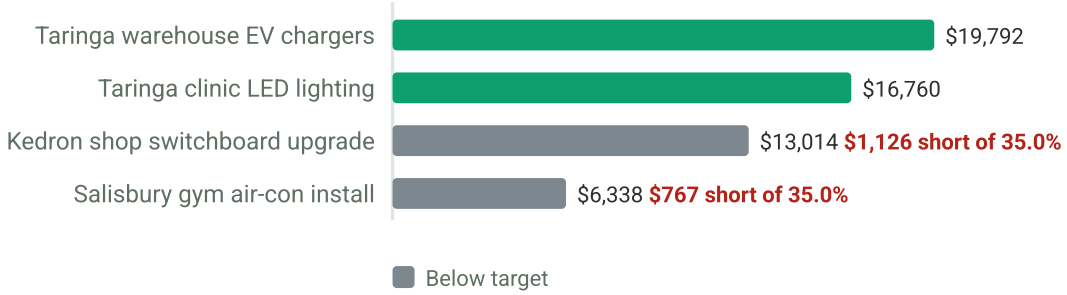
Gross margin jobs need to break even
33.0%
covers overheads and time not charged (February)

Job gross margin on each installation invoiced in February 2026

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

2 of the 4 installation jobs invoiced in February made less than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The Salisbury gym air-con install made a 31.2% job gross margin: 71.5 h of technician time ($4,862) and $1,300 of subcontractors on a $20,300 job. Jobs need 33.0% gross margin just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

2 installations under the 35.0% target, worth about $1,893 between them on $60,700 of revenue. The biggest gap, Kedron shop switchboard upgrade: 32.2% gross margin, 2.8 points under the 35.0% target: about $1,126 on $40,400 of revenue in February. It's below the 33.0% needed to cover overheads, too.

Type of job: Call-outs and repairs

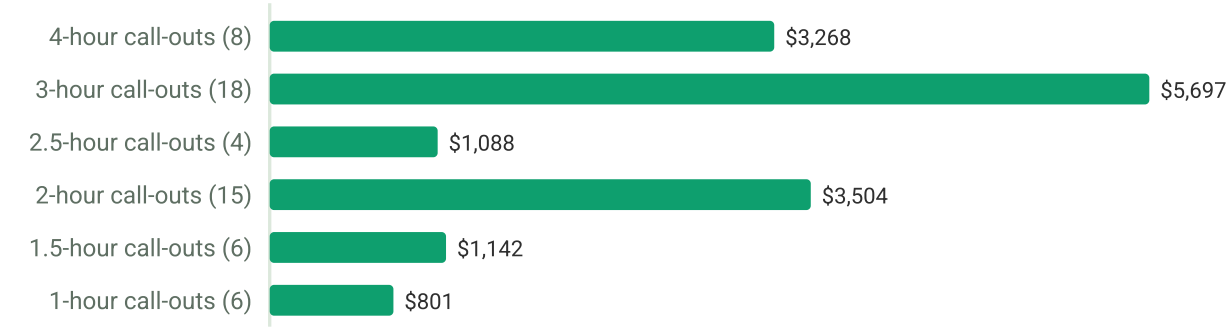
Job gross margin, February · Call-outs and repairs	Job gross margin, January · Call-outs and repairs	Gross margin jobs need to break even	Technician time charged, February	Materials charged, February
48.3%	**47.6%**	**33.0%**	**$22,982**	**$9,126**
target 35.0%	target 35.0%	covers overheads and time not charged (February)	71.6% of call-out revenue	$7,020 at cost, plus 30%

Job gross margin on call-outs by length, February 2026

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

57 call-outs in February billed $22,982 of technician time and $9,126 of materials ($7,020 at cost plus 30%), and made a 48.3% job gross margin between them. Gross margins run from 40.5% to 52.7% by length: the hourly rate covers technician time comfortably, so the gross margin mostly moves with how much material goes on the van.

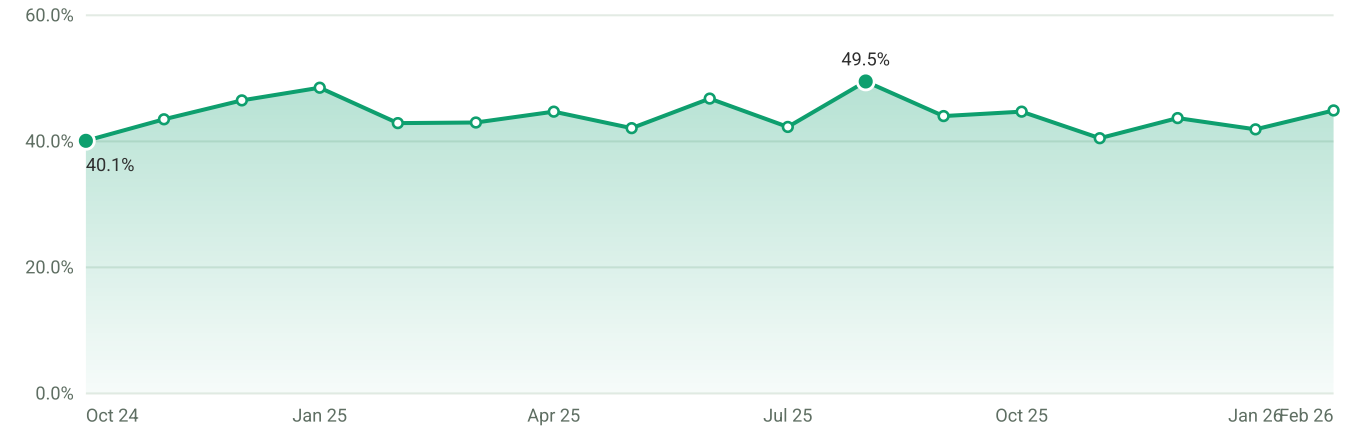
What you'd do about it

All call-outs: 48.3% gross margin, 13.3 points over the 35.0% target ($4,262 ahead on $32,108 in February).

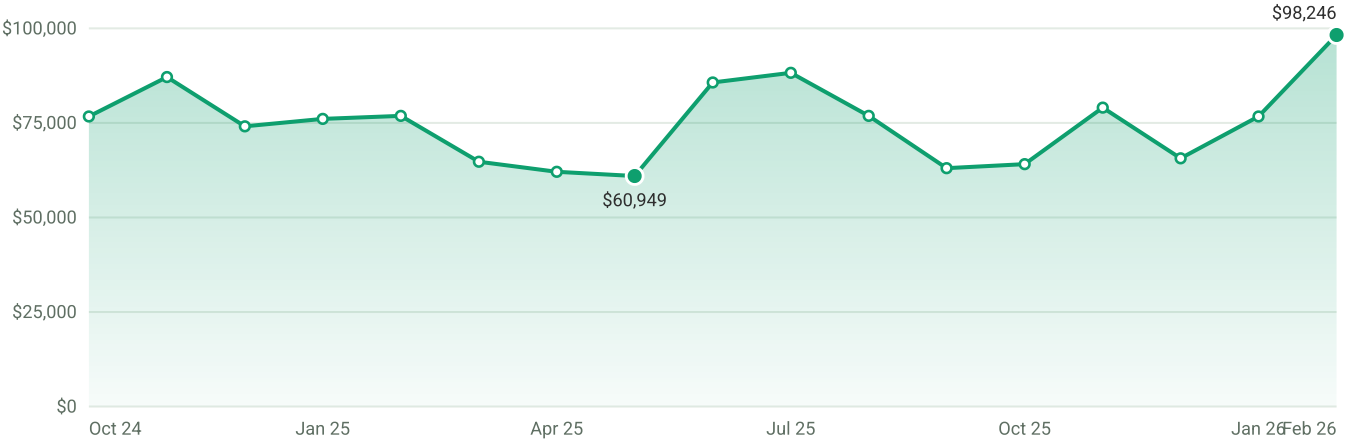
Every type of job at once

Job gross margin by month

All · Gross margin %



All · Gross margin $



Tap a month for its workings. Every month, by line, is in the spreadsheet download.

Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.